

1-2-1: Identifying the Problem in Troubleshooting

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Explain the importance and techniques to identify a problem, given a scenario.

Learner Objective: *Explain the importance and techniques to identify a problem, given a scenario*

Description: In this episode, the learner will examine the initial step of the network troubleshooting methodology, identifying the problem. We will explore a variety of techniques that can be implemented to help the learner identify a networking problem quicker.

- What is the initial step in the troubleshooting methodology?
 - o Identifying a Problem in Troubleshooting
 - ♣ The initial step in troubleshooting where the specific issue or malfunction within the network is recognized.
 - What are some of the techniques we can utilize to identify problems?
 - o Gather information
 - ♣ Collect data and logs that can shed light on the issue.
 - ♣ Previous troubleshooting documentation
 - ♣ Configuration information
 - ♣ System and network logs
 - ♣ Firewall logs
 - o Question users
 - ♣ Interview users who might have noticed the problem or its effects.
 - ♣ Ask open-ended questions such as "Describe what the symptoms that you have been noticing," instead of "Have you had issues with the network?". this is a "yes" and "no" or closed-ended question
 - o Identify symptoms
 - ♣ Pinpoint the exact nature and characteristics of the problem.
 - o Determine if anything has changed
 - ♣ Check for recent changes in
 - ♣ Network configuration (if possible, check configuration management database)
 - ♣ Software updates
 - ♣ Environmental factors
 - o Duplicate the problem, if possible
 - ♣ Reproducing the issue can help to better understand its conditions and triggers.
 - o Approach multiple problems individually
 - ♣ Break down complex issues into simpler, individual problems for easier management
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- Additional Resources:
 - o If applicable